



△ Japanese infantry on campaign in China

1937

WAR BETWEEN CHINA AND JAPAN

After establishing a presence in northern China in 1931, Japan sought to expand its control with a full-scale invasion. Beijing, Shanghai, and Nanjing fell to the Japanese, who committed major atrocities, and China's government was forced to relocate southward to wage a guerrilla resistance campaign that ended only with Japan's defeat in World War II.

1938

GERMANY THREATENS CZECHOSLOVAKIA

German claims on the Sudetenland region of Czechoslovakia, where many German nationals lived, led Hitler to threaten to take the disputed territory by force. The Czech government looked to France and Britain for support, but this was not forthcoming. A general mobilization ensued, attracting over a million volunteers, but Hitler was not deterred.



△ Nazi Sudetenland badge of honour



△ Adolf Hitler salutes Sudetenland Germans

1938

1937 The Indian National Congress
political party wins India's first provincial elections

1937 The first working jet engine is built in England by engineer Frank Whittle

"I believe it is peace for our time."

NEVILLE CHAMBERLAIN, 1938

1938

MUNICH AGREEMENT

Seeking to appease Hitler over his claims in Czechoslovakia, British Prime Minister Neville Chamberlain and France's premier Édouard Daladier flew to Munich to sign an agreement accepting the German occupation of the Sudetenland and establishing a commission to determine the future of other disputed areas. The move led to the dismantling of Czechoslovakia as an independent state.



▽ Neville Chamberlain returns from Munich